PROJECT BASED LEARNING PROJECT REPORT

SAHAYAK

A Prototype for Public Problem Reporting and Resolution System

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Submitted By

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Department: _____

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1. CLARITY OF PROBLEM DEFINITION (PO1)

1.1 Background

In many areas, public problems such as damaged roads, garbage, or open drains stay unresolved for a long time. One reason for this is poor communication between citizens and the department responsible for fixing the issue. Citizens do not have one common platform where they can raise such problems, so they often depend on informal or unofficial ways of complaining, such as calling an office directly or asking a local representative.

Because there is no proper system to track a complaint after it is raised, many complaints are simply forgotten. There is no fixed person responsible and no deadline for action, so problems can remain pending for a long time without any update.

1.2 Problem Definition

- Public issues such as road damage, pollution, poor sanitation, and local crime are often left unattended.
- Complaints get delayed because of middlemen and unclear responsibility between departments.
- There is no fixed time limit for reviewing, approving, or prioritizing a reported problem.

1.3 Key Issues Identified

- There is no transparency in how a reported problem is handled after it is submitted.
- There is no system to separate urgent problems from minor ones.
- Approval of complaints gets delayed due to unclear ownership among authorities.
- Citizens have no way of checking the current status of their complaint.

1.4 Need for a Centralized Platform

Based on the problems listed above, there is a clear need for a single digital platform where citizens can report public issues and also track what happens to them afterwards. Such a platform should:

- Give citizens one trusted place to report a problem, instead of relying on multiple informal channels.
- Make sure every complaint is looked at within a fixed time period, such as 48 hours.
- Allow problems with more public support to be treated with higher priority.
- Help build trust between citizens and the government by showing that action is actually being taken.

2. DESCRIPTION OF PROJECT CONCEPT (PO4)

2.1 Project Definition

SAHAYAK is a prototype of a digital platform that allows citizens to report public and civic problems and track their status until they are resolved. It is meant to work as a direct channel between citizens and the concerned government authority, instead of relying on informal complaints or word of mouth.

The main users of the platform are citizens, who report problems, and government authorities such as municipal offices, police, or local representatives, who review and act on these reports.

2.2 Project Concept

The idea behind SAHAYAK is to make the complete life cycle of a complaint visible, from the moment it is reported to the moment it is resolved. Every problem submitted on the platform goes through a simple flow:

If a problem is not acted upon within the expected time, it is automatically escalated so that it does not get ignored. The main objectives of the project are to:

- Give citizens a direct platform to report public problems.
- Ensure that every problem is reviewed and approved within 48 hours.
- Prioritize problems based on their severity and the level of public support they receive.
- Increase transparency and accountability in the way local problems are handled.
- Allow the community to take part in deciding which problems should be resolved first.

2.3 Major Features

Feature	Description
Public Issue Reporting	Citizens can report problems related to roads, pollution, sanitation, and local crime directly on the platform.
Community Visibility	Other citizens can reshare or upvote a reported problem, which helps highlight issues that affect more people.
Priority Management	Problems are tagged as high, medium, or low priority depending on their severity and support.
Time-Bound Approval	Every submitted problem must be reviewed and approved within 48 hours.
Escalation System	If a problem is not handled within the expected time, it is automatically escalated.

Direct Authority Assignment	Problems are sent directly to the concerned authority, such as the municipal body, police, or a local representative.

2.4 Working / Basic Workflow

1 The citizen submits a problem along with a short description, an image, and the location.

2 The problem stays in a ‘Pending Approval’ state for a maximum of 48 hours.

3 The concerned authority reviews the problem, approves it, and assigns a priority based on its severity and the support it has received from the community.

4 Once approved, the problem shows status updates that remain visible to the public.

5 Problems marked as high priority are handled first. If there is a delay, the problem is escalated automatically.

6 Other citizens can reshare or upvote the problem, which can increase its priority.

3. STUDY OF THE LITERATURE SURVEY (PO5)

3.1 Comparable Platforms Studied

Before designing SAHAYAK, a few existing complaint and grievance reporting systems were studied to understand how they work and what could be learned from them.

CPGRAMS (Centralized Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System): This is a Government of India platform that allows citizens to file grievances against government departments and track their status online. Studying it gave an idea of how a government-run complaint tracking system is generally structured.

FixMyStreet: This is a UK-based platform that lets citizens report local issues such as potholes, broken street lights, or littering by marking the location on a map. This platform was useful in understanding how location and image-based reporting can be used for civic issues.

MyGov / Swachhata App: These are examples of Indian government platforms that allow citizens to report civic issues such as garbage or sanitation problems in their area, which are then forwarded to the concerned department.

3.2 Relevance to SAHAYAK

From studying these platforms, a few useful concepts were identified and adapted for SAHAYAK:

- Reporting a problem along with an image and location, similar to FixMyStreet.
- Routing a complaint to the correct authority or department, similar to CPGRAMS.
- Allowing the public to see the status of a complaint, instead of it being handled only internally.

However, most of the platforms studied did not have a strict time-bound approval system or a community-based priority mechanism. This is why these two features were specifically added to SAHAYAK.

4. PROJECT FEASIBILITY (PO2)

4.1 Technical Feasibility

SAHAYAK can be developed as a web-based platform with a database to store problem reports, their status, and priority. Since the core functionality mainly involves form submission (description, image, location), status updates, and basic approval or escalation logic, it does not require any complex or resource-heavy technology. This makes the prototype realistic to build within the scope of a college project.

4.2 Operational Feasibility

The platform is designed to fit into how citizens and local authorities already handle complaints, just in a more structured way. Citizens only need to fill a simple form to report a problem, and authorities only need to review, approve, and update its status. Since the roles of both citizens and authorities are kept simple, the platform is operationally practical to use without needing major training.

4.3 Future Feasibility

Beyond the current prototype, the following enhancements can realistically be added in the future:

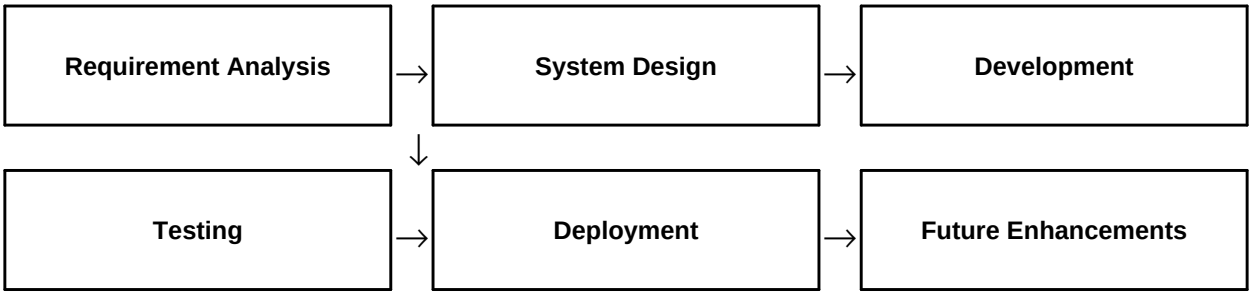
- AI-based automatic categorization of complaints.
- Regional language support and voice-based reporting.
- Integration with existing official government portals.
- Performance dashboards for authorities to track resolution rates.
- A penalty system for departments that repeatedly cause delays.

These additions are not part of the current prototype but are realistic directions for extending the project in the future.

5. ROADMAP OF PROJECT & DISTRIBUTION OF WORK AMONG TEAM (PO11)

5.1 Project Roadmap

The project was planned and carried out in six phases, moving from understanding the problem to identifying future improvements.



5.2 Development Phases

Phase	Description
Phase 1: Requirement Analysis	Understand citizen and authority requirements, identify the major problems, define the scope of the project, and study existing complaint-handling systems.
Phase 2: System Design	Design the system architecture, plan the database structure, design the user interface, and define the workflow for citizens and authorities.
Phase 3: Development	Develop the frontend and backend, implement login and authentication, and build the complaint submission, approval, priority, and escalation logic.
Phase 4: Testing	Test the major features, identify and fix bugs, and check that the citizen and authority workflows work correctly.
Phase 5: Deployment	Deploy the application, set up the database and server, carry out final testing, and prepare project documentation.
Phase 6: Future Enhancements	Plan for AI-based categorization, regional language and voice support, integration with government portals, and a dedicated mobile application.

5.3 Distribution of Work Among Team

Team Member	Work / Responsibility
Member 1	_____
Member 2	_____
Member 3	_____
Member 4	_____

CONCLUSION

SAHAYAK is a prototype that tries to solve a simple but common problem: the lack of a proper system for reporting and tracking public issues. By introducing a fixed approval time, a priority system, and visible status tracking, it aims to make the process of reporting a civic problem more transparent and accountable.

Some of the expected benefits of the system are:

- Faster acknowledgment of public problems.
- More transparency in how complaints are handled.
- Greater accountability from the authorities involved.
- Citizens getting a say in which problems are treated as urgent.

Overall, SAHAYAK is meant to work as a small step toward a more organised and citizen-friendly way of handling public grievances.